



Home



My Network



Jobs



Messaging



Notifications



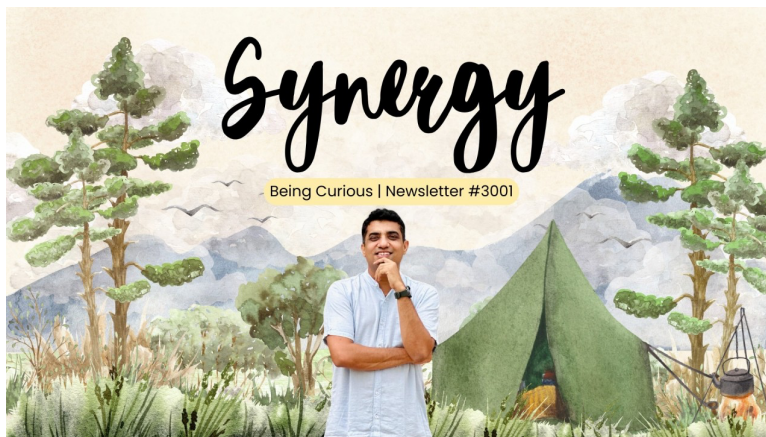
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For Business

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I see things others don't!

**Vikas Surani**

Global Vice President – Growth | TEDx Speaker | IIMA



June 21, 2025

Hey Curious Minds,

Thirty weeks in, and I'm realizing something about myself that I've never said out loud: I see connections everywhere. While others focus on their piece of the puzzle, I'm the one looking at the whole damn picture, figuring out how it all fits together.

It's my superpower. It's also exhausting.

The thing about being a Connector

People come to me with problems that seem unrelated. Sales is struggling. Operations is confused. Strategy feels disconnected from execution. And I'm sitting there thinking, "Of course it's all connected. Can't you see it?"

But they can't. And that's not their fault—they're deep in their lanes, doing what they do best. Someone has to be the one who steps back and says, "Wait, what if we connected this to that?" Someone has to turn the vision into something real.

That someone is usually me.

What I actually Do (when it works)

I don't manage people. I don't even really manage projects. I manage the

spaces between things. The gaps where stuff falls through. The places where one team's output should become another team's input, but doesn't.

I see a sales conversation and think about how it connects to our product roadmap. I hear a customer complaint and see the operational change we need to make. I watch a team struggle and realize they need a connection to another team that's solved the same problem.

It's not magic. It's just... seeing the whole system instead of the parts.

The Hard Part

Here's what nobody tells you about being the synergy person: You're always translating. You're always explaining why A connects to B to people who only care about A. You're always fighting for resources for connections that don't show up on anyone's individual scorecard.

And sometimes you're wrong. Sometimes the connection you see isn't real, or isn't worth the effort. Sometimes you push for integration when people just need to focus on their own thing.

But most of the time? Most of the time, the magic happens when you bring the right pieces together.

What I'm Learning

The best leaders I know aren't the ones with all the answers. They're the ones who can see how different answers fit together. They're the translators, the bridge-builders, the people who make $1+1=3$.

If you're reading this and thinking, "Yeah, that's me too"—good. We need more people who see the connections. Who turn vision into reality by bringing the right pieces together at the right time.

If you're reading this and thinking, "I don't see it that way"—also good. We need you focused on your piece. Just don't be surprised when someone like me comes along and asks how your piece connects to the bigger picture.

Stay curious (and keep connecting the dots),

Vikas

Comments

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 **Ritu Purohit Bhalavat**  · 1st
Oracle Transformation Leader | SCM & Procurement Solution Archi... 6mo ...

This one is lit **Vikas Surani**

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Vikas Surani Author

Global Vice President – Growth | TEDx Speaker | IIMA

5mo ...

Ritu Purohit Bhalavat glad this one resonated with you. Keep an eye out for those connections—which you very much have! It's a powerful skill.

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Rupesh Vaishnav · 1st

Assistant Professor, Training Placement officer, Program Co-Ordin...

6mo ...

Definitely worth reading

Like · 🗨️ 1 | Reply · 1 reply



Vikas Surani Author

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Rupesh Vaishnav Thanks, Rupesh! Really appreciate it. If you think it could help or inspire your students, please feel free to share it with the next gen!



Saumendra Rathod · 1st

Oracle Cloud Project/Programme Management

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But does connecting dots add value especially when it involves modern day Sherlock Holmes?

Funny · 🤔 1 | Reply · 1 reply



Vikas Surani Author

Global Vice President – Growth | TEDx Speaker | IIMA

5mo ...

Saumendra Rathod Especially when the “know-it-alls” are in the room—connecting dots gets a lot more entertaining!

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Yatin Mirani · 1st

Senior Business Development Leader | Scaling AI & Digital Transfo...

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Insightful 🧐

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Vikas Surani Author

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Yatin Mirani Thanks, Yatin! Glad you found it insightful. Always happy to share and support your growth—keep pushing boundaries!

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Rafik Mansuri · 1st

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Worth Reading!

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Vikas Surani Author

Global Vice President – Growth | TEDx Speaker | IIMA

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Rafik Mansuri Thank you, Rafik! Glad you found it worth reading. Your work in the community is truly inspiring—appreciate your support!

Like · 🗨️ 1 | Reply | 8 impressions



Being Curious

A weekly newsletter where I share quick insights, experiences, and lessons learned from my journey.



Rohit, Mona and 2,446 connections are subscribed

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